

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Court feels sting of shutdown

Employees to go without pay at Dirksen US Courthouse, where some trials are already canceled

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

The ongoing federal government shutdown is starting to have dire consequences at Chicago's Dirksen U.S. Courthouse, where money has run out to pay staff and some jury trials have already been canceled amid growing uncertainty.

In one bit of good news, however, the Administrative Office of the U.S. Courts notified all federal courts nationwide this

week that there are sufficient funds to continue to pay jurors and grand jurors for up to about three months.

U.S. District Chief Judge Virginia Kendall told the Tribune on Friday that the announcement was "out of the blue," but the exact date the funding would run out was unclear.

"I think we have funding to make it to the end of the year as far as paying jurors," Kendall said.

Still, the ongoing shutdown, which began Oct. 1 and currently

has no end in sight, prompted Kendall to announce Friday the U.S. District Courts in Chicago are now entering "Phase 2" of its shutdown operations, stopping salary payments to courthouse employees and reducing operations at the clerk's office to only "excepted activities" such as constitutional functions.

While the courthouse will remain open, Kendall said that workers — from docketing employees to clerks and courtroom staff — will get their last

paycheck on Oct. 24. After that, they'll be working without pay as "excepted" employees in order to keep the court's constitutional functions running, she said.

Kendall said the courthouse staff is keeping a stiff upper lip, but the prospect of working without pay is daunting especially in an uncertain economy.

"Regardless of your political position, it's critical that the court has stay open for those seeking

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FAA turbulence

Since the shutdown began Oct. 1, the Federal Aviation Administration has reported controller shortages in cities across the U.S., from airports in Boston and Philadelphia to control centers in Atlanta and Houston. Flight delays have spread to airports in Nashville, Dallas, Newark and elsewhere. And there has been an increase in absences among security screeners. **Business**

ELECTION 2026

US HOUSE

Hopefuls' personal loans fund campaigns

In crowded fields, some war chests are not what they seem

By Dan Petrella,
Olivia Olander
and A.D. Quig
Chicago Tribune

With dozens of Illinois Democrats vying for four open congressional seats next year, at least a half-dozen candidates — including a former U.S. representative mounting a political comeback — have poured six-figure personal loans into their campaigns as they strive to stand out in crowded primary fields, new federal campaign finance filings show.

Former U.S. Rep. Melissa Bean, a moderate Democrat who held Illinois' largely north-west suburban 8th Congressional District seat for three terms before losing to a Republican in 2010, joined the 2026 primary Sept. 10, less than three weeks before the latest fundraising deadline.

On Oct. 2, Bean's campaign touted "over half a million dollars" raised in just over two weeks as a "sign of the growing momentum behind her campaign." What the news release left out, however, was that more than half of that — \$299,000 out of a nearly \$531,000 total — came from Bean herself via a personal loan made on the final day of the reporting period covering July through September, according to Federal Election Commission records.

The timing of Bean's loan might be intriguing, but several contenders across the four open congressional districts — the 2nd, 7th, 8th and 9th — also have dug into their own

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INSIDE

Survivors seized in boat attack

The U.S. took survivors into custody after its military struck a vessel in the Caribbean — the first attack that anyone escaped since President Donald Trump began launching deadly attacks in the region last month, a defense official and another person familiar with the matter said Friday. **Nation & World**

C The saga of Saints quarterback Spencer Rattler and the Bears' Caleb Williams will come full circle when the two square off on Sunday. **Chicago Sports**

"They are not coming to protect us. They are coming to terrorize our communities. This is like an attack against people of color. And we won't tolerate it."

— Claudia Galeno-Sanchez, of Chicago's Back of the Yards neighborhood



Immigrant rights activists, including Alex Garduno, right, protest outside the Swap-O-Rama flea market in Chicago's Back of the Yards neighborhood on Friday, a day after about 13 people were arrested by federal agents. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

'Us against y'all'

Trump administration petitions Supreme Court to allow deployment of National Guard in Chicago area following temporary restraining order

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Calling the recent court ban on National Guard deployment in Illinois part of a "disturbing and recurring pattern," the Trump administration on Friday asked the U.S. Supreme Court to allow the president to dispatch troops in the Chicago area pending appeal, escalating the president's conflict with Democratic governors over using the military on U.S. soil.

The temporary restraining order entered last week by U.S. District Judge April Perry "improperly impinges on the President's authority and needlessly endangers federal personnel and property," the solicitor general said in its petition asking the high court to stay Perry's order while the case plays out in the courts.

The 43-page petition also asked for an immediate administrative stay "given the pressing risk of violence," but the court had taken no action on that as of 5 p.m. Friday.

The filing said Illinois' resis-



Members of the Texas National Guard assemble at the Army Reserve Training Center in Elwood on Oct. 7. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

tance to a National Guard deployment mirrors similar actions still unfolding in California and Oregon. It asked that President Donald Trump be allowed to deploy some 700 troops in Illinois — 300 from the Illinois National Guard and another 400 federalized out of Texas earlier this month.

The Supreme Court asked lawyers for Illinois to respond by 5 p.m. Eastern time on Monday.

In response to the administration's appeal, Illinois Gov. JB Pritzker wrote in a social media post Friday that the president "will keep trying to invade Illinois

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Swap-O-Rama raid, arrests draw outrage

By Gregory Royal Pratt
and Caroline Kubzansky
Chicago Tribune

When masked federal agents arrived at the Swap-O-Rama flea market, the people standing between the might of the United States government and the livelihoods of the immigrants who make up its vendors and customer base were working-class employees in red sweaters.

They faced armed federal agents wearing camo and bearing guns.

"One of our people said this is private property and they said to that person, 'If you resist we'll arrest you, we're coming in anyway,'" Ted Joseph, the flea market's co-owner, told the Tribune.

A battery of armed agents covering their faces entered the open-air shopping staple of the Back of the Yards neighborhood Thursday morning and took a number of people away. Community members

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Body camera order

A judge on Friday clarified that all agents must have body cameras in the field as part of a temporary restraining order over aggressive tactics. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Broadview protests

Illinois State Police arrested 11 people in a scuffle with hundreds of protesters demonstrating Friday outside ICE's Broadview center. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Feds arrest officer

Immigration officials arrested a Hanover police officer for allegedly overstaying a tourist visa, but the village has defended his status. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

